Removing Tangled and Overhead Cables along Residential Roads in Pulilan, Bulacan

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The Issue:

- Tangled and crisscrossed overhead cables, also known as “spaghetti wires”
- Along Residential Roads in Pulilan, Bulacan
- Residents, pedestrians, and motorists as well as emergency responders are affected

Why is this a problem?

- Open ground hazards on low-hanging wires
- Fire hazard due to cable friction and arcing
- Below safety standards - overhead wires in some areas sag as low as 3–4 meters
- Overloaded utility poles

Causes

- Continuous addition of new utility lines
- Lack of audits and regular inspection
- Overloaded utility poles

Proposed Resolution

- Tag-Bundle-Purge method led by Pulilan Municipal Engineering Office
  1. **Tag** - A 30-day grace period for companies to tag and color-code their active lines
  2. B**undle** - bundling of loose wires with UV resistant ties
  3. P**urge** - physically remove any untagged or abandoned "dead" wires.
- The Pulilan Municipal Engineering Office, Meralco, telecommunications companies, and Barangay officials should unite

Supporting Evidences

- According to BFP, over 30% of fire incident in the Philippines is due to electrical ignition by overloading, loose connection, arcing, and pinched wires
- In Pulilan, overhead wires in residential roads were observed sagging as low as 3 to 4 meters
- Iloilo City successfully removed their tangled and overhead wires through mandatory city ordinance

Expected Outcomes

Outcome 1: The risk of fire and electrical hazards will significantly decrease

Outcome 2: Emergency response times will improve

Outcome 3: infrastructure will become more resilient against typhoons

Conclusion

- The "Tag-Bundle-Purge" method offers a practical and effective solution.
- Pulilan Municipal Engineering Office, Meralco, telecommunications companies, and Barangay officials should unite and take action

“The time to act is now; A safer and cleaner community begins with each one of us.”

Thank you / Questions

References

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